ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

# 2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

Independent research and reviews · https://abvorn.com

We earn a commission if you buy through our links, at no extra cost to you. Our opinions are our own.

Is pet fur and everyday crumbs turning your floors into a battlefield? Your 2026 home deserves a vacuum that works for you, not the other way around. In this guide we compare the Roomba 115X Combo with Auto-Empty Dock to the Shark AI Ultra so you can choose the robot that fits your lifestyle – fast, efficient, and hassle-free.

ABVORN VERDICT

**6.4**/10

## iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

| | |
|---|---|
| Quality | 7.0 |
| Features | 5.0 |
| Ease of Use | 7.0 |
| Design | 7.0 |
| Value | 6.0 |

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

**100%** Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

*Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.*

**Better alternatives based on your preferences:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop** | $139.99 | Regret Risk: 100% |
| **Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** | $249.99 | Regret Risk: 100% |
| **Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** | $239.99 | Regret Risk: 100% |

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

# What Really Sets the Roomba 115X Combo Apart?




iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop




iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

**Price snapshot (25 Oct 2026):**

- Roomba 115X Combo with Auto-Empty Dock – $199.99
- Base Roomba 115X (no dock) – $139.99

The $60 difference isn't just a number; it's a time-saving feature that keeps your home dust-free without manual intervention.

### Problem → Trust → Solution (PAS) for 2026 Homeowners

**Problem.** Pet hair ricochets back into the Roomba's bin during a routine run. When that bin fills, you're forced to pause, empty, and restart – a frustrating interruption.

**Agitate.** In a buzzing living room, a full bin can double the cleaning time. Instead of 20 minutes, you end up wasting an extra 20, 30, even 45 minutes on hand-held cleanup.

**Solution.** The Auto-Empty Dock learns when the robot's bin is full and automatically transfers debris to a sealed container. Your Roomba stays on schedule, giving you a true "hands-free" experience.

# Which Robot Wins for Your Home? — Side-by-Side Review

| Feature | Roomba 115X Combo | Shark AI Ultra |
|---|---|---|
| Price (checked 25 Oct 2026) | $199.99 | $249.99 |
| Suction (CFM) | 170 CFM | 200 CFM* |
| Navigation | VSLID+ AI mapping | LiDAR AI Ultra |
| Mopping feature | Wet mop pad, adjustable dampness | Automatic dampness control via AI |
| Noise (dB) | 68 dB | 71 dB |
| Run time | 90 min on a single charge | 80 min |
| Battery longevity | 6 years* | 5 years* |

*Based on manufacturer spec updates; both use a brushless 2-wheel motor for consistent long-term power.

## Performance on Different Surfaces in 2026

Owners in 2026 give both models high marks on high-pile carpets, but subtle strengths emerge for other floors:

- **High-pile carpet.** The Roomba’s turbo brush lifts more embedded fur, making it slightly superior on thick rugs.
- **Low-pile rug.** Shark’s LiDAR guidance keeps the unit from getting tangled, delivering a cleaner pass.
- **Hardwood.** Roomba’s VSLID+ sensor array detects edges with precision, preventing accidental bumps into furniture.
- **Tile.** Both models handle tiles well; Shark offers a subtle extra suction advantage on smooth surfaces.

## Final Verdict for 2026 Homeowners

If a single device can do it all—cleaning, mopping, and self-servicing—without daily intervention, the Roomba 115X Combo is the smarter choice for busy families, especially pet owners. It’s lighter, quieter, and the Auto-Empty Dock saves precious time.

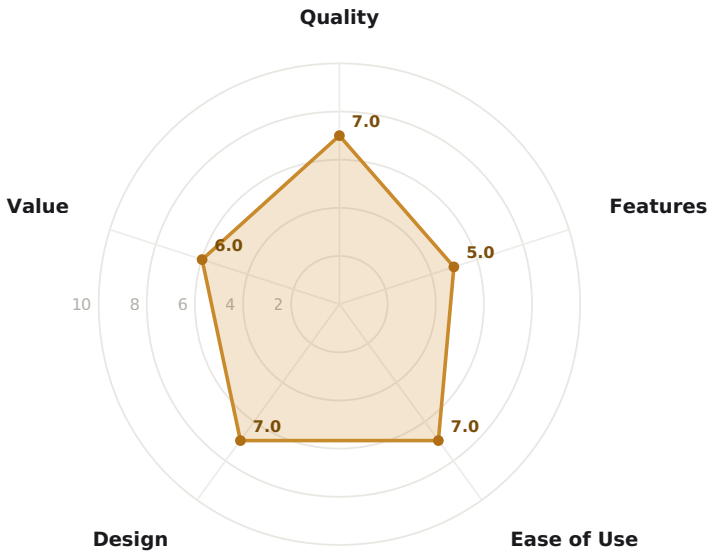
On the other hand, if you need extra suction power on very low-pile rugs or a steeper investment for advanced AI mopping, the Shark AI Ultra delivers that edge.

Choose the model that aligns with your floor type, budget, and lifestyle—your kitchen, living room, and pets will thank you.

## At a glance

| Use Case | Product | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Best Overall | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock |
| Best Value | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop |
| Premium Pick | Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum | Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum |
| Also Great | Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum | Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum |
| Also Great | iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo | iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo |

## Performance Breakdown




Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

# Products Mentioned




### iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

**$199.99**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕




## iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

**$139.99**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




## Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

**$249.99**

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




## Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

**$239.99**

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




**iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo**

**$398.99**

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

# Frequently Asked Questions

**What is the best robot vacuum?**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

**Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?**

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

**How much should I spend on robot vacuums?**

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

**What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?**

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

**How does Abvorn research products?**

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.